

INTRADEPARTMENTAL CORRESPONDENCE

May 21, 2026
1.14

TO: The Honorable Board of Police Commissioners

FROM: Chief of Police

SUBJECT: CALIFORNIA PUBLIC RECORDS ACT DATA

RECOMMENDED ACTION

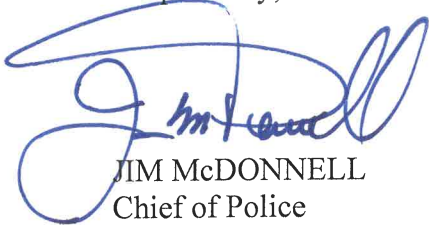
It is recommended that the Board of Police Commissioners REVIEW and APPROVE this report regarding a California Public Records Act (CPRA) data.

DISCUSSION

Risk Management Legal Affairs Division reviewed CPRA statistical data associated to the Department and prepared this report. This report includes the number of open CPRA requests, number of open CPRA requests that have not received a response within 10-14 days; number of open CPRA requests open for more than 14-days with a documented exception or consent; and number of open CPRA requests exceeding 14-day response without a documented exception or consent.

If you have any questions, please contact Captain Javier Sanchez, Commanding Officer, Risk Management Legal Affairs Division, at (213) 486-8730.

Respectfully,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Jim McDonnell", is written over a printed name and title.

JIM McDONNELL
Chief of Police

Attachment.

California Public Records Act Data
Risk Management Legal Affairs Division
May 21, 2026

Background

The Risk Management and Legal Affairs Division's California Public Records Act (CPRA) Unit was tasked with providing CPRA statistical data. This includes: (1) providing the number of open CPRA requests; (2) number of open CPRA requests that have not received a response within 10-14 days; (3) number of open CPRA requests open for more than 14-days with a documented exception or consent; and (4) number of open CPRA requests exceeding 14-day response without a documented exception or consent.

The CPRA was enacted in 1968 when public records requests were mainly submitted by mail, telephone, or in person, limiting their volume and frequency. In 1981, the statute added the 10-day response and the additional 14-day response for "unusual circumstances." Since 1981, technology has allowed requests to be submitted instantly online from anywhere in the world. These changes have improved access and transparency but also led to a significant increase in both the volume and complexity of CPRA requests received by large agencies.

Effective January 1, 2019, Senate Bill (SB) 1421, and effective January 1, 2022, SB 16, amended Section 832.7 to establish certain exceptions to confidentiality, requiring public disclosure of records relating to officer-involved shootings, uses of force resulting in death or great bodily injury, or sustained findings of excessive force or failure to intervene during an incident of excessive force. Disclosure is also required for sustained findings of sexual assault; dishonest conduct related to reporting, investigating, prosecution of crimes, and another officer's misconduct; discriminatory conduct based on protected characteristics; and unlawful arrests or searches.

Data Request

As of April 13, 2026, the Department is managing:

- Total open CPRA requests: **1,860**
- Open CPRA requests pending response, 10-14 days from request: **458**
- Open CPRA requests exceeding 14 days with a documented exception or consent: **749**
- Open CPRA requests exceeding 14 days without a documented exception or consent: **3**
- Open CPRA requests not exceeding 10-14 days with documented exception: **650**

The CPRA requests have more than doubled, climbing from 3,656 in 2020 to 8,123 in 2025, representing approximately 122% growth over five years, with a 93% surge between 2023 and 2025. This rapid escalation has outpaced current staffing capacity, leaving the Department stretched to meet the demand.

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YEARLY COMPARISON-CPRA REQUESTS RECEIVED

YEAR	REQUESTS RECEIVED	SB1421	CPRA
2025	8123	606	7517
2024	5554	382	5172
2023	4207	323	3884
2022	3732	300	3432
2021	3508	322	3186
2020	3656	224	3432

Procedure

The Department follows a structured process to ensure timely and compliant responses under CPRA. The handling of CPRA requests begins when a request is received through the City of Los Angeles Next Request portal, by telephone, email, facsimile, or United States Postal Service mail. Each request is promptly reviewed and routed to the appropriate CPRA or California Senate Bill (SB) 1421 unit. The request is then assigned for a records search and exemption review. Within ten days, the Department notifies the requester whether responsive records exist. The Department may extend this timeframe by up to fourteen additional days due to “unusual circumstances.” When responsive, non-exempt records are identified, the Department proceeds with disclosure as promptly as possible. A common misconception about CPRA requests is that records must be produced within the 10-day period or during the 14-day extension granted for unusual circumstances. In fact, agencies are only required to notify requesters whether responsive records exist within that timeframe. Record production can occur thereafter.

Personnel records are processed by the SB 1421 unit, which require production of records within forty-five days. Requests may be extended up to 180 days when records involve active investigations or are being reviewed for prosecution or are being litigated in a court proceeding. Modern CPRA requests often require processing large volumes of digital records and video evidence, including body-worn video footage, and coordinating across multiple divisions and bureaus, all of which increase processing time.

The Department relies on intradepartmental partners to review, redact, and furnish disclosable records. Because many of these divisions have limited staff, production of records is often delayed. Additionally, increased writ litigation requires staff to prioritize urgent court deadlines, diverting resources from standard processing. Consequently, these combined resource constraints slow overall report processing, despite ongoing efforts to meet legal requirements.

The volume of CPRA requests continues to significantly grow year after year. From January to April 2026, the Department has received 3,282 requests, up from 2,498 during the same period in 2025, an increase of 784 requests, or 31.4%. This sustained growth continues to place mounting pressure on staff responsible for records review, processing, and compliance.

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YTD COMPARISON-CPRA REQUESTS RECEIVED

YEAR	REQUESTS RECEIVED	SB1421	CPRA
2026	3282	296	2986
2025	2498	117	2381
2024	1698	129	1569
2023	1382	84	1298
2022	1207	78	1129
2021	1115	74	1041
2020	1120	51	1069

Effective January 1, 2026, California Senate Assembly Bill (AB) 1388 is expected to further increase request volume and strain limited staffing. AB 1388 is a California law aimed at strengthening transparency and accountability in law enforcement misconduct investigations. The law prohibits police agencies from entering into agreements that destroy, remove, hide, or restrict the disclosure of misconduct investigation records or influence investigative findings. AB 1388 also amended Penal Code Section 832.7 so that such agreements are subject to disclosure under CPRA.

Therefore, AB 1388 creates another provision for additional requests, adding to the already high volume of CPRA and SB 1421 related requests. The statute adds an additional strain on Department personnel, particularly as analysts already manage a high caseload and staffing shortages continue due to attrition. Because CPRA requires law enforcement agencies to respond within statutory deadlines, the increased workload may create further operational challenges and increase the risk of delayed responses, litigation, reputational harm, and financial liability if additional staffing resources are not provided.

Staffing

Currently, the two units that handle all the requests are the CPRA and SB 1421 unit. The below are tables that represent their current and past staffing:

CPRA Unit Staffing		
Rank	Current Staffing	Previous Staffing
Detective III	1	1
Senior Management Analyst I	2	3
Management Analyst	5	10
Senior Administrative Clerk	1	1

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SB 1421 Unit Staffing		
Rank	Current Staffing	Previous Staffing
Detective III	1	1
Sergeant II	1	1
Detective II	1	1
Management Analyst	5	9
Senior Administrative Clerk	1	0

Prepared by:
Risk Management Legal Affairs Division